DEVELOPER PIPELINE PLAYBOOK | ENGLISH EDITION

The Pipeline Playbook for Property Developers

Where pre-sales really get lost — and how real pipeline operators spot it.

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Novalure Novalure | PropTech Sales System for real estate developers and agents

WHAT THIS PLAYBOOK HELPS YOU INSPECT

A system, not another marketing folder.

This document reveals pipeline gaps and helps prioritize the next operating steps with more clarity.

Note: This playbook is a strategic working guide and not a guarantee of specific outcomes.

1. What most developers don’t want to see right now

Time-to-sell on new schemes has lengthened materially since 2021 — across both Irish and UK markets. Lenders haven’t softened their pre-sales requirements to match. If your scheme is at 30 % off-plan when the bank needed 55 %, you don’t have a marketing problem. You have a pipeline problem.

Daft.ie, myhome.ie, rightmove and zoopla still deliver enquiries. But the quality has dropped measurably since 2023, and the cost per qualified lead keeps rising. Anyone who isn’t feeling that isn’t measuring properly. Most developers think they have a reach problem. They actually have a filter problem.

Four out of ten mid-sized developers in Ireland and the UK lose at least one unit per quarter to a qualified lead that simply went cold. Nobody notices. Nobody measures it. It happens anyway. That’s what makes it expensive: it doesn’t sting acutely — it bleeds slowly.

Traditional agencies still deliver campaigns, not pipelines. They write headlines, place ads, optimise click-through rate. What happens between the click and the reservation is their blind spot. That blind spot is where 2026 pre-sales targets are won or lost.

Bottom line: The gap between “enquiries are coming in” and “units are going out” is the unresolved problem in the IE and UK developer market in 2026. That gap is exactly what we specialise in.

2. The pipeline leaks we see most often

Four patterns show up in almost every developer audit we run. They rarely sit at the sales desk. They sit before, beside, or after it. And they cost — quietly, continuously, invisibly.

Leak No. 1 — The enquiry that was never properly qualified

An enquiry comes in. First name, last name, maybe a sentence. Someone calls back, books a viewing. The person who shows up is not mortgage-approved-in-principle, not actually owner-occupier, and not realistically buying in the next twelve months. Sales hour burned. Viewing without a reservation. Most developers call this “just how it is”.

We see this in 8 of 10 developer audits: there is no pre-viewing qualification. Three or four precise questions before the appointment would prevent 30 to 50 % of unproductive viewings. Which questions, in what order, with what level of commitment — that’s where the leverage sits, and that’s deliberately not the point of this document.

Diagnostic hint: If your sales team converts fewer than 1 in 4 viewings into a reservation, the problem almost never sits at the sales desk. It sits before it.

In the audit we show you exactly where — using your last 20 enquiries.

Leak No. 2 — The invisible tracking death

You spend a marketing budget on Meta, Google, daft.ie or rightmove featured listings. You see clicks, enquiries, maybe viewings. What you don’t see: which channel actually delivers reservations, and which one just delivers expensive clickers. iOS privacy changes, cookie consent, broken pixel implementation — the GDPR-compliant server-side tracking you actually need is, in practice, either missing or misconfigured at most developers we audit.

In one audit last quarter we found, in 12 minutes, a tracking gap that was making 31 % of paid enquiries invisible. The team had no idea. Consequence: three months of budget optimisation against the wrong data.

Diagnostic hint: If your monthly marketing report shows “clicks”, “enquiries” and “CPL” — but not “reservations per source after 60 days” — you are flying blind.

In the audit we check this against your live setup. What we find each time no longer surprises us — it surprises the developer.

Leak No. 3 — The handover that suffocates in the inbox

A qualified enquiry lands at 18:42 on a Friday. It goes into the sales inbox. Monday 10:14 a.m., someone calls back. 63 hours later. In that time, the buyer has contacted two more developers. One of them replied — Saturday morning, automated, with a first qualification question and a viewing-link. Guess where the buyer's mind is three days later.

What sits inside the CRM of a developer who is currently winning is not "more data fields". It is a handover that gives the salesperson, in 30 seconds, everything they need: source, initial intent, budget, timing, follow-up history. Nothing more — but reliably.

Diagnostic hint: If your negotiators "sort their emails" before every callback, you are burning 15 to 25 % of response time. Multiply that by 8 to 12 enquiries a week, across one quarter, and you can do the maths on missed reservations.

What the right CRM handover looks like for your business depends on your scheme mix and your sales tempo. We show it in the audit.

Leak No. 4 — The 14 days when the lead goes cold

60 to 70 % of new-build buyers do not decide at the first viewing. They compare, they hesitate, they wait on mortgage approval-in-principle, they talk to their partner. What happens between day 2 and day 21 decides whether you sell or your competitor does. Most developers do the same thing here: nothing. Or worse — three generic "come back and have another look" emails.

A systematic follow-up sequence is no longer a marketing luxury in 2026. It is the difference between 30 % and 55 % viewing-to-reservation conversion. We won't prescribe here what that sequence has to look like — the answer depends on your buyer mix, your build phase and your reservation mechanics.

Diagnostic hint: Look at your last 50 cold leads. How many of them saw a single meaningful touchpoint from you in the 21 days after first contact, that wasn't labelled "newsletter"? If the answer is below 70 %, you have a multi-million problem hiding here.

In the audit we quantify it — against your real numbers, not industry averages.

Bottom line: Spotting these four leaks is the easy part. Closing them in the right order is the work. And that's where it gets interesting.

3. The 5-minute self-check

Seven questions. Score each from 1 (not at all true) to 5 (fully implemented and lived). Be honest. The result is only for you.

#	Question	1–5
1	We know, for every active scheme, how many qualified enquiries come in each week — broken down by source.	
2	Our conversion tracking has been audited externally, not just “set up” internally.	
3	Before every viewing, the prospect is filtered through at least four qualification questions.	
4	Inbound enquiries get a first qualified response within 60 minutes — including outside office hours.	
5	We have an automated email sequence that keeps prospects warm for 14+ days without anyone writing it manually.	
6	We know how many of our enquiries go cold without a reservation after 21 days — and why.	
7	Our sales team and our marketing function review top leads weekly — not just monthly reports.	

Scoring

7–14 points — You’re relying on luck. If you’re being honest, you already knew that. The question is what you’re going to do about it.

15–25 points — You have building blocks, but no system. This is where most pipeline gets lost — not at the bottom, but halfway competent with invisible gaps.

26–35 points — You’re ahead of most. The only question is how scalable your system is — and whether it can handle a second market or a second language.

4. Why most fixes don’t actually work

When a developer notices that the pipeline isn’t holding, most reach for one of three levers. In practice none of them solve the actual problem — and one of them makes it worse.

“Spend more on advertising”

Doesn’t work when the pipeline leak sits behind the ads. More enquiries through the same gaps means more wasted budget. We’ve seen developers double their ad spend with their pre-sales rate flat. Because money was never the problem.

“New website / new funnel”

Doesn’t work when the CRM and the sales handover don’t follow. A polished scheme landing page sitting on top of weak qualification, weak handover and weak follow-up is a façade. It improves the form. It does not improve the sale.

“Hire an SDR / hire another negotiator”

Doesn’t work when lead quality is structurally poor. You burn salary on unqualified enquiries. Developers who try to hire their way out of a pipeline problem don’t solve it. They scale it.

A PropTech sales system is not an advertising add-on, not a website refresh, not a hiring substitute. It is the sales infrastructure inside which advertising, websites and people start to actually work. Order matters in 2026: infrastructure first, then advertising, then people.

5. What a working system looks like

We deliberately describe the end picture only in outline here. What it looks like in your business depends on scheme mix, buyer profile and build phase. The components, however, are the same in every setup.

1. A scheme-specific funnel that qualifies enquiries before they reach the sales team — usable bilingually if your investor mix demands it.

2. A CRM handover that gives the negotiator everything in 30 seconds: source, intent, budget, timing.

3. An automated follow-up sequence that stays useful through the first 21 days — without anyone writing it manually.

4. A weekly pipeline report that shows where money is leaking — by source, by stage, by negotiator.

We build exactly that. In 10 to 15 working days from asset sign-off. Bilingual EN/DE, native in both. No lead promises, with a clearly defined system delivery guarantee. What that means for your specific scheme is the audit conversation.

6. The next step: 30 minutes that can change everything

What it is

A 30-minute diagnostic call on Microsoft Teams, with Franz Romih directly.

What you get

- Three concrete pipeline leaks in your current setup, named against examples from your own enquiries.
- An honest fit assessment — even if the answer is that we're not the right partner.
- Clarity on the right next step — with us or without us.

What it is not

- Not a sales call.
- Not a generic pitch.
- Not a written free report.

Who should book it

- Developers with a real pre-sales or scheme-launch deadline in the next 4 to 8 weeks.
- Decision-makers with budget and mandate authority.
- Anyone who genuinely wants their pipeline status diagnosed against their actual project — including those selling cross-border to DACH investors.

Who should not book it

- "Just looking" calls.
- Anyone without sales or marketing authority.
- Anyone hunting for a guaranteed lead or reservation count.

Contact

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Bottom line: If after these 9 pages you're thinking: "Makes sense, but I need clarity for my specific situation" — that's exactly why the Pipeline Audit exists. 30 minutes. Honest. Concrete. No charge.

THE NEXT STEP

Have your current lead system reviewed.

If you want to see which gaps in your current setup are costing real pipeline, book a Pipeline Audit. We review funnel logic, lead qualification, CRM handover and reporting against your actual system.

Book Pipeline Audit